



The Chase - Map creation Tutorial

Hej, and thank you so much for helping us with the next exciting map for **The Chase**! Here's a quick tutorial of how it works and what to look out for! If you have any questions, don't hesitate to contact us! (hej@thechase.site or our dedicated map-builder discord [channel](#))

General information

- **Map size:** We generally aim to get a map radius of around ~20 minutes to most corners of the map from the starting point, using public transport. A useful website for a first rough estimate is: <https://www.mapnificent.net/>. In Berlin and Stockholm, we ended up with 45-60 km² as a reference. You can see the area of the map by clicking on the area you surrounded with a border.
- **Start location:** Pick something at the center of the map. Ideally, it is something that has connections with most networks, so the escapers have plenty of choices to go to in the beginning of the game. A main train station is mostly suitable, but also check that the meeting point is a somewhat nice place to be and hang out for a while 😊
- **Clue Points location:** It's always nice to set Clue Points at a point of interest in real life. So a nice square, church, view,... Some Clue Points will be at not so interesting spots due to balancing, but it's still nice if people can see some of the beautiful parts of the city as well.
Keep the distance between individual Clue Points at around 10-15 minutes by foot, the overall amount of Clue Points will result from this.
Make sure the Live-Location and Freeze locations are not super easily

accessible, so you have to invest a bit more time to activate them. (For example not directly at public transport locations)

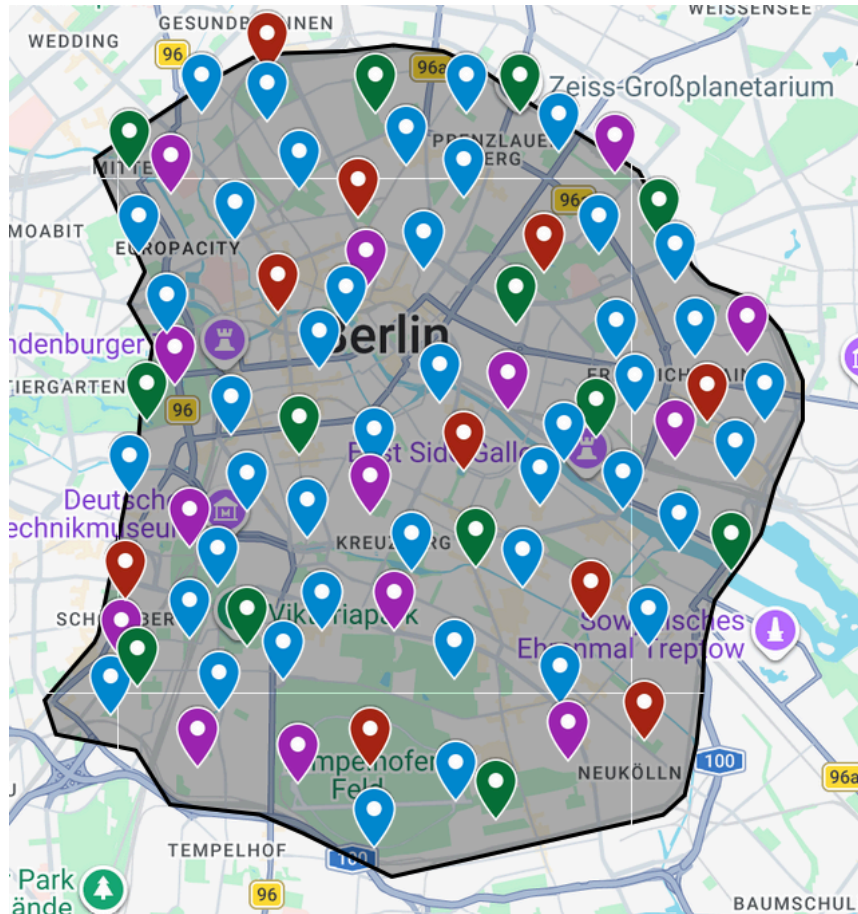
- **Number of Clue Points:** Overall, there should be around the same number of Freeze and Live-Location Points, aim at around something between 8-12 per type.

Fill the gaps with the Ticket-Check and Photo spots.

- **Clue Point Duration:** Keep in mind that we can alter the durations for freeze and live locations individually for your city to make the game more balanced. We usually start at 6min for the freeze and 10 for the live location but can adjust this.

Here are the Berlin and Stockholm maps as an example, so you can get some inspiration:





Procedure

1. Create a new Map

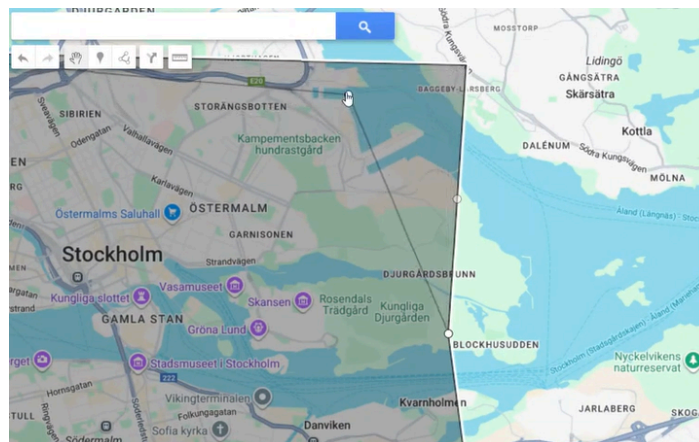
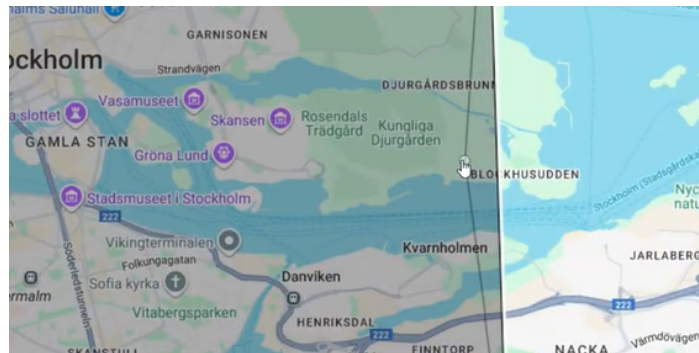
1. Go to www.mymaps.google.com
2. Click "*Create New Map*"

2. Create the Map border

1. Create the Map Border:
 - a. click "*Draw a line*" in the top, under the search bar
 - b. click "*Add line or shape*"
 - c. Create a rough border first, and call it "Border"



- d. Adjust the border, by drag and drop of the adjustment points between to points, and the points itself (Tip: if you accidentally moved the entire area/map, just press Cmd / Strg + z, to undo that)



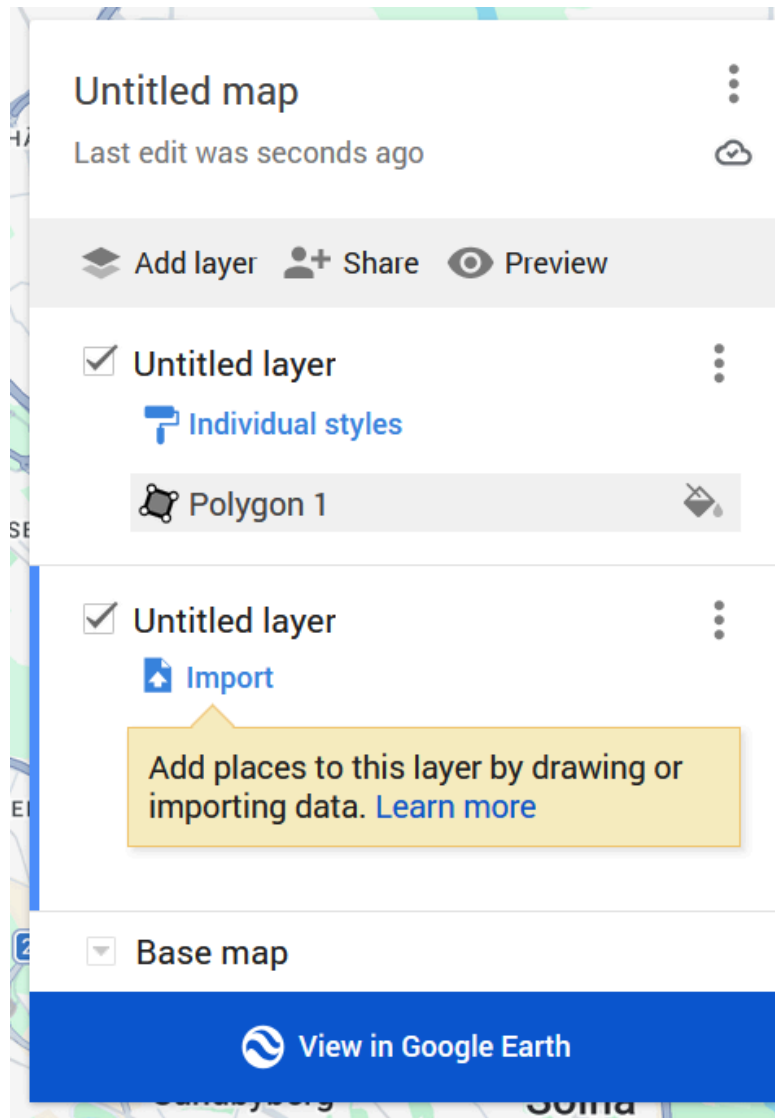
- e. Refine until you're satisfied



3. Add the Clue Points

1. Click on "Add layer"

- a. the second layer you created is now selected, so it shows blue on the side.
To edit the border again, you have to select the border layer first.



2. Start by adding the Start Location.
 - a. Click on "Add marker" in the top under the search bar.
 - b. Click on the map, where you want to place it
 - i. Sometimes it's easier to hide the border area while placing the points.
You can do so by simply unselecting the layer for the border
 - c. Give it a name (this will be displayed in the game)

Assigning types of Clue points to the placed points

1. After you placed all Clue Points you wanted, you can assign them types by colouring them in a certain colour.

2. Click on the point you want to assign, and click on "*Style*" (colour bucket).
3. The individual colours for the Clue Points are:
 - a. Live Location: Red (RGB 165, 39, 20)
 - b. Freeze: Green (RGB 9, 113, 56)
 - c. 360 video: Blue (RGB 2, 136, 209) (they will appear as green in the app, but as they are the most common and blue is the standard colour you have less work this way)
 - d. Ticket-Check: purple (RGB 156, 39, 176)

Go out and test it! 🎉

Send us a link to your map so we can include it in our test app.

Then, go out and play, to test out how the map is balanced. Do Escapers or Chases have a clear benefit somewhere? Are there areas where you can too easily combine freeze and live location points? How is the map area? Is there something that should (should not) be included?

Then, adapt the map on mymaps, tell us what you changed and give it another go



Fine tuning the durations:

Clue Point Durations:

As mentioned above we can tune the duration of Freeze and Live Location. The default is 6min for Freeze and 10min for Live Location. Just check after the first one or two rounds how it feels. Currently we have it set for 6 and 10min in all our maps so the first step should be to increase/decrease the number of Freeze/Live Locations if things feel unbalanced-

Closing In Phase:

In the final phase of the game, Escapers are no longer allowed to use public transport. The timing of this phase depends on the city: In Stockholm, the Closing-

In phase starts 30 minutes before the game ends and in Berlin, it starts only 15 minutes before the end.

This difference reflects the density of public transport in each city. Berlin has a much denser public transport network than Stockholm. If the Closing-In phase in Berlin were extended to 30 minutes, Chasers would gain a significant advantage because they could catch up much more easily using the dense network of buses, trams, and U-Bahn/S-Bahn lines.

In Stockholm, large areas are harder to reach using public transport, so a 30-minute phase keeps the game more balanced. The sparser network means Chasers cannot close the gap as quickly, even with more time.

The goal of the Closing-In phase is to increase tension towards the end of the game while keeping it fair for both sides. By adjusting the duration to the local transport coverage, you can ensure that Escapers still have a realistic chance to evade capture, and Chasers cannot rely solely on fast public transport to win.

For the beginning choose a value between 30 and 15min and then adjust, when the map feels one sided.

Thank you so much for helping us out! Let us know when you want to play, so we can give you a free access code!